



Zhoukoudian Caves, China

Some of the most important fossils of *H. erectus* were found in these limestone caves 30 miles (50 km) from Beijing.

Java, Indonesia

The earliest known human fossils in East Asia—of *Homo erectus*—come from this island.

Flores, Indonesia

H. floresiensis remains are known from just one cave on this island.

Homo—meet the family



We and our extinct relatives belong to the *Homo* genus. A second Latin word, such as *sapiens*, completes each species' name.

Homo habilis

(2.4–1.4 million years ago)

H. habilis ("Handy man") is thought to have been the first hominin species to make stone tools.



Homo georgicus

(1.8 million years ago)

Known only from a single fossil site in Georgia, this may have been the first hominin to leave Africa.



Homo ergaster

(1.9–1.5 million years ago)

As tall as modern humans and with a similar build, it looked very different than its apelike ancestors.



Homo erectus

(1.8 million–200,000 years ago)

Along with *H. ergaster*, *H. erectus* ("Upright man") is known to have used stone hand-axes.



Homo antecessor

(1.2 million–500,000 years ago)

Around 780,000 years ago, *H. antecessor* became the first hominin to reach western Europe.



Homo heidelbergensis

(600,000–250,000 years ago)

With a big brain and a muscular body, this species could hunt large animals and make complex tools.



Homo floresiensis

(95,000–17,000 years ago)

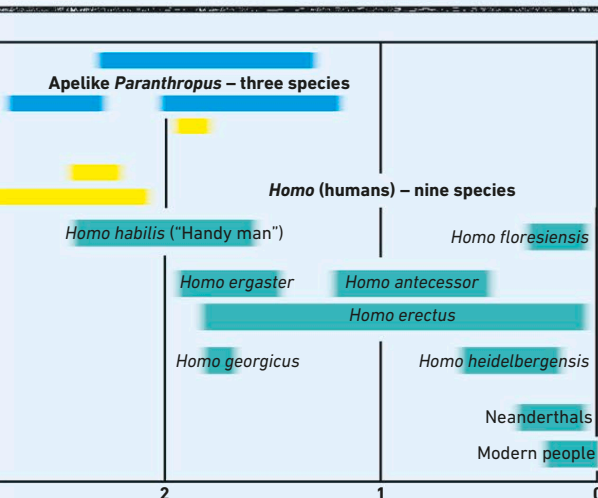
Nicknamed "Hobbit", *H. floresiensis* was tiny—just over 3 ft 3 in (1 m) tall. It lived until very recently.



Homo neanderthalensis, or *Neanderthals*

(200,000–30,000 years ago)

This successful species was skilled at hunting, made and used stone tools, and buried its dead.



Family tree

This chart shows the "family tree" of hominins from *Australopithecus* onward. Scientists are still working to understand the relationships between different hominin species.